

Forward plan — reading order and glossary

Date: 2026-06-15
From: COMPASS
To: Charles Levine
Purpose: One-page companion for sun reading. Use this when shorthand in other docs loses you.
Start here if lost: this file → then the numbered list below.

Correct reading order (do not skip)

Read in sequence. Later docs assume earlier ones.

Step	Document	Read for
0	This file	Order + glossary
1	<code>forward_plan_background.md</code>	Plain-English story; mini jargon sheet
2	<code>20260615_1045_COMPASS_to_Charles_forward_plan_and_questions.md</code>	Action plan; §6–§7 your locks (what C1, D10, V1 mean)
3	<code>sports/documents/20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md</code>	Alex PD12: four priorities; quality vs congestion
4	<code>20260615_1200_COMPASS_PD12_reassessment.md</code>	Ladder relabel; B-lite closure — after steps 1–3
5	<code>20260615_1100_VECTOR_claim_language_table.md</code>	What you may / may not claim — §E, §F
6	<code>20260615_1012_SCOUT_to_COMPASS_minimal_model_closure.md</code>	Green/yellow checklist; §7 Alex one-liner

Do not read second: PD12 reassessment (step 4) before forward plan (step 2) — it references IDs and locks you have not seen yet.

Skip for first pass: Round 1–5 correspondence files, duplicate `1156` COMPASS drafts, `PROJECT_STATUS_AND_NEAR_TERM_PLAN.md` (long; overlaps forward plan).

Two different “Tier” systems

Docs use **Tier** for two unrelated things. Check context.

A. Scientific tiers (story arc)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1	Phenomenon — inverted-U on LOO proxy (mostly done)
Tier 2	Minimal mechanism — generative POC; D10 packages it
Tier 2.5	Model-guided features — quality vs congestion (PD12)
Tier 3	Predictions — named candidates, not fully proven
Tier 4	Manuscript — write the paper

B. Question tiers (your decisions — forward plan §6)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1 questions	Answer first — unblocks SCOUT, PEER, VECTOR (§6 items 1–10)
Tier 2 questions	Softer prose/methods — OK to say “ use agent defaults ” (§6 items 11+)
Tier 3+	Alex meeting, AWS, optional routes — not blocking this week

Tier 1 question IDs (memorize these five blocks):

- **SCOUT**: Q-SCOUT-9 (folder path), Q-D10 (go on export bundle)
- **PEER**: C1 (OpenAlex tiers), C2 (CSV names)
- **VECTOR**: C12–C13 (predictions + outline), V1–V3 (manuscript priority + timing)
- **COMPASS**: Q-DEFAULTS (accept Tier 2 defaults?)

Copy-paste batch is in forward plan §7.

Rung / ladder (plain English)

Not a code pipeline. **Steps in the paper argument**, in order:

- Rung 1

Phenomenon

→ inverted-U exists (Army, basketball; tenure preliminary)
- Rung 2

Minimal model

→ talent-only fails; congestion-in-score POC (basketball)
- Rung 2.5

Model-guided feats

→ quality vs congestion columns (mostly built; D10 exports)
- Rung 3

Predictions

→ #1 near-threshold, #2 Λ – candidates, not fully validated
- Rung 4

Manuscript

→ VECTOR drafts under Path II

Ladder = climb these rungs when writing; do not jump from “we found a curve” to “submit the paper” without the middle steps Alex (PD12) cares about.

Paths (manuscript architecture)

Path	Meaning	v1?
Path II (locked)	3 empirical inverted-U legs + one basketball generative POC; honest axis mismatch	Yes
Path I	Generative sim must match LOO pool-quality axis bin-for-bin	No — parallel / post-v1

Path II = Charles’s “**manuscript-first**” lock (2026-06-11).

Predictions #1 and #2 (Charles clarification)

Agents locked **two prediction slots** for manuscript structure — **not** “two proven results.”

#	Name	Empirical status today
#1	Near-threshold heterogeneity	Candidate. Basketball has exploratory 4D figure; not formal cross-domain test.
#2	Peak shift with Λ	Placeholder / prose hook. No finished Λ figure in repo.

Do say: “primary prediction **directions**.”

Do not say: “predictions are fully validated across all settings” (claim table §F).

Shorthand glossary

Term	Plain English
COMPASS	Cross-project planner — sequencing, not domain code
CODA	Army agent
SCOUT	Basketball agent
PEER	Tenure agent
VECTOR	Manuscript / theory agent
PD12	Alex Gates paper-directions meeting, 2026-05-20
STANDING BY	Agent done debating; waiting on Charles only
Correspondence experiment	Rounds 1–5 agent mail in <code>3-Master_Plan/</code> — complete
LOO	Leave-one-out — peer pool excluding yourself
<code>poolq_loo</code>	LOO teammate pool quality (main empirical x-axis)
<code>crowding_smooth</code>	LOO congestion — density of viable peers above threshold
Λ (Lambda)	Global distinction capacity (slots, boards, draft picks)
D10	SCOUT script that packages figures/tables into one export folder (~1–2 sessions)
Claim table	VECTOR list: Supported / Preliminary / Unsupported per claim
B-lite closure	Mechanism POC + one model-guided measurement + one prediction readout + honest limits + D10
Axis table	Maps model quantity ↔ empirical column ↔ setting
Wang structure	Paper arc: phenomenon → mechanism → predictions
Wang move	Predict something you did not use to find the curve
Layer B	Tenure Cox cells 10–12 in <code>540</code> — pre- submission , not draft blocker
Dakota v03	Dissertation RTF spine VECTOR uses for section order
Generative POC	Small sim showing talent-only fails and congestion bends curves

Term	Plain English
Pool mean	Whole-roster average — generative readout axis (≠ LOO axis)
PD12-A	Accept 5-rung ladder relabel? (COMPASS rec: yes)
PD12-B	Accept B-lite closure wording? (COMPASS rec: yes)
PD12-C	Optional PEER pool_size supplementary read? (your call)
PD12-D	Tell Alex P1/P4 deferred at next meeting? (COMPASS rec: yes)

What to do after reading

1. Answer **Tier 1** in forward plan §6–§7 (or paste §7 batch).
 2. That unlocks: SCOUT D10 → PEER inference CSV → VECTOR draft.
 3. Schedule Alex for Army estimand (Tier 3) when ready.
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Temporary reader’s guide. Archive when no longer needed.